MODULE 50 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

What Changed: C02 to C03

Five domains instead of four, a lower passing score, AI in every domain, four scope reversals, and a long list of services that left.

DOMAIN Cross-cutting EXAM WEIGHT All five MODULE 50 of 52

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C03 is not a refresh of C02. It is organised along a **different axis**, and some correct C02 answers are now **wrong**.

Exam mechanics

ITEM	C02	C03
Questions and time	75 in 180 minutes	75 in 180 minutes
Scored questions	65, plus 10 unscored	65, plus 10 unscored
Passing score	750	720
Domains	4	5
Guide structure	Knowledge and skills	Numbered skills only

ON THE EXAM

The 30-point drop in the passing score is real: the 100 to 1000 scale is unchanged.

Where C02's domains went

C02 DOMAIN	WEIGHT	MOSTLY BECAME
Organizational Complexity	26%	Security, networking, cost visibility
New Solutions	29%	Architecture, plus IaC to operations
Continuous Improvement	25%	Operations, plus posture and reliability
Migration and Modernization	20%	Shares 15% with resilience

ON THE EXAM

Migration's share roughly halves. Security rises to 25% and operations to 20%.

New subject areas

AREA	WHERE IT APPEARS
AI and ML: Bedrock, SageMaker AI	12 skills, all five domains
Data lakes, Iceberg, Clean Rooms	Task 1.5
Multi-tenant isolation	Skill 1.1.13
Post-quantum: ML-DSA, ML-KEM	Skill 2.2.4
IPv6 and dual-stack	Task 1.4
Responsible AI controls	Task 2.5

ON THE EXAM

AI is architected, not built: training and fine-tuning are out of scope.

Scope reversals

SERVICE	C02	C03
Amazon VPC Lattice	Out of scope	Skill 1.1.7
AWS Fault Injection Service	Out of scope	Skills 4.3.2, 4.3.5
AWS Resilience Hub	Out of scope	Skills 4.2.3, 4.2.5
Application Recovery Controller	Out of scope	Skill 4.2.4

ON THE EXAM

Material that says these are out of scope was right for C02 and is wrong for C03.

Services that left the in-scope list

AREA	GONE FROM C03
Migration	Migration Hub, Application Discovery Service, Migration Evaluator, Snow Family
Security	Macie, Detective, Audit Manager, Firewall Manager, Service Catalog
Compute and delivery	Batch, App Runner, Wavelength, Image Builder, SAM, Amplify
Cost	Trusted Advisor, Billing Conductor

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Absent from the list is weaker than explicitly out of scope, but do not choose them as answers.

Old answers, new answers

REQUIREMENT	C02-ERA ANSWER	C03 ANSWER
Ship petabytes physically	Snowball Edge	Data Transfer Terminal
Discover and assess servers	Migration Hub, ADS	AWS Transform
Rehost servers	Application Migration Service	AWS Transform MGN
Chaos testing	Custom scripts	Fault Injection Service
Service mesh on EKS	App Mesh	VPC Lattice
Quantum-safe key exchange	Not examined	KMS ML-KEM

ON THE EXAM

If a remembered answer names a closed or renamed service, find its successor.

> A retailer wants to prove its checkout service survives losing an Availability Zone. The test must be repeatable, run in production, and stop automatically if customer errors rise.
>
> A C02-era runbook suggests a script that terminates instances at random.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A. An AWS Fault Injection Service experiment from the AZ availability scenario, with CloudWatch alarm stop conditions

B. The random termination script, run weekly

C. An AWS Resilience Hub assessment only

D. Manually change network ACLs to block one Availability Zone

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What should the solutions architect recommend?

A FIS experiment
Repeatable AZ scenario, stops on alarms.

B Random script
Not an AZ loss, no stop condition.

C Assessment only
Estimates resilience; does not test it.

D Manual ACL change
Not repeatable, no automatic stop.

THE SIGNAL

C02 called FIS out of scope. C03 names it: controlled fault injection with stop conditions.

> A film studio new to AWS must move 400 TB from a site with a 100 Mbps uplink within three weeks. Staff can drive storage media to a nearby city.
>
> A colleague's C02 notes say to order Snowball Edge devices.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Order Snowball Edge devices

B DataSync over the existing uplink

C Take the media to an AWS Data Transfer Terminal and upload over its high-throughput connection

D Order a 10 Gbps Direct Connect connection

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What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Snowball Edge

No longer available to new customers.

B DataSync

100 Mbps moves about 22 TB in three weeks.

C Data Transfer Terminal

AWS's stated physical-transfer replacement.

D Direct Connect

Weeks to provision; the site still has one uplink.

THE SIGNAL

New customer, physical transfer: Data Transfer Terminal, not Snowball.

> A manufacturer new to AWS has 800 VMware virtual machines. It needs dependency maps, right-sized recommendations and a wave plan before migrating.
>
> A C02 study guide recommends AWS Migration Hub with Application Discovery Service agents.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Application Discovery Service agents on every VM

B AWS Transform discovery and assessment

C Migration Evaluator

D Migration Hub Strategy Recommendations

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What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Discovery Service
Closed to new customers since Nov 2025.

B AWS Transform
Discovery, assessment and wave planning, in scope.

C Migration Evaluator
Off the C03 in-scope list.

D Strategy Recommendations
Part of Migration Hub, closed to new customers.

THE SIGNAL

Discovery and assessment for a new customer: AWS Transform.

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> A bank's services run on EKS, ECS and Lambda across 40 VPCs in several accounts. Each call between services must be authorised per request with IAM, with no overlapping-CIDR workarounds.
>
> Its EKS services used AWS App Mesh until last year.

What should the solutions architect recommend?

A Amazon VPC Lattice service networks with IAM auth policies

B Re-create the App Mesh configuration

C Transit Gateway with security groups

D A PrivateLink endpoint for every pair of services

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What should the solutions architect recommend?

A VPC Lattice
Mixed compute, cross-VPC, IAM per request.

B App Mesh
Discontinued on 30 September 2026.

C Transit Gateway
Network reachability, no per-request IAM; CIDRs clash.

D PrivateLink per pair
Hundreds of endpoints to manage.

THE SIGNAL

Out of scope in C02, central in C03: VPC Lattice.

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> A healthcare group with 50 accounts wants threats detected in every account, and all findings, including vulnerability findings, gathered in one place and prioritised by risk.
>
> A C02 module suggested Amazon Detective and Amazon Macie for this.

What should the solutions architect design?

A Amazon Detective in every account

B Amazon Macie for threat detection

C A self-built SIEM on EC2

D GuardDuty and Inspector with delegated administration, aggregated and correlated in AWS Security Hub

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What should the solutions architect design?

A Detective

Investigation, not detection; off the in-scope list.

B Macie

Finds sensitive data, not threats; off the list.

C Self-built SIEM

Heavy operations for a managed capability.

D GuardDuty, Inspector, Security Hub

Detect, scan, correlate and prioritise centrally.

THE SIGNAL

Detection and aggregation are in scope; forensic investigation is not.

> A government contractor exchanges encrypted data with a partner. Policy now requires that the key exchange resist future quantum attacks, using a NIST standard algorithm.
>
> The private key must stay in a FIPS 140-3 Level 3 HSM, with the least custom cryptography.

What should the solutions architect use?

A An RSA-4096 key in AWS KMS

B An ECC key agreement in AWS KMS

C An ML-KEM key in AWS KMS, sharing the public key and using Encapsulate and Decapsulate

D An ML-DSA key in AWS KMS

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What should the solutions architect use?

A RSA-4096

Not quantum-resistant at any size.

B ECC agreement

Not quantum-resistant.

C ML-KEM in KMS

FIPS 203 key exchange, private key in KMS HSMs.

D ML-DSA

Signatures, not key exchange.

THE SIGNAL

Brand new to C03: ML-KEM in KMS, announced one day before the guide was published.

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What to carry out of this module

- **Five domains by concern**; passing score **720**.
- **AI in every domain**: architect it; training is out of scope.
- **Reversals**: Lattice, FIS, Resilience Hub, ARC are in.
- **Gone**: Migration Hub era tools, Snow Family, Macie, Detective.
- A remembered C02 answer naming a departed service is now a distractor.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Carry the networking, storage and identity knowledge. Re-check everything else.